

The bird dropped the diamond stud on the floor and went out in search of little worms for the young ones.

Ramayya's wife noticed the jewel as she was sweeping the floor. She picked it up with delight and wore it.

Ramayya questioned her angrily, "From where did you get this diamond-stud?"

"I found it lying here yesterday and took it. That is all."

"We should go and handover it to the village **magistrate**. Tomorrow if the police should come and search our house, it will be a **disgrace** to us."

In the neighourhood of Meenakshi Ammal, the talk went thus: "I forgot and left it in the bathroom. Kuppayi, the maid-servant must have swept it out. She is very careless and **ignorant**."

The mother, Meenakshi Ammal, **consoled** her little girl saying, "Let us search and find it. Don't tell father yet. He would go into a rage if he knew that you had lost the diamond nose-stud."

DO YOU KNOW?

A bird's eye takes up about 50 percent of its head; our eyes take up about 5 percent of our head. To be comparable to a bird's eyes, our eyes would have to be the size of baseballs.

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